

Behavioral & Emotional Support in Schools

Learner guide | SWP-020 | School of School Social Work

This guide supports a three-part learning sequence for Behavioral & Emotional Support in Schools. By the end of the course, you should be able to apply trauma-informed, positive, and inclusive support for students' behavioural and emotional needs.

Practice notice: Apply the law, organisational policy, supervision requirements, and approved referral pathways that govern your setting. This material supports learning and does not replace urgent safeguarding, clinical, or legal procedures.

Learning objectives

- Apply trauma-informed, positive, and inclusive support for students' behavioural and emotional needs.
- Apply the key ideas from Behaviour as communication.
- Apply the key ideas from Tiered supports.
- Apply the key ideas from Collaboration and review.

Course structure

Module	Focus	Suggested study time
1. Behaviour as communication	development, trauma, neurodiversity, culture, and avoiding punitive assumptions	10 to 15 minutes
2. Tiered supports	classroom strategies, individual plans, crisis response, and referrals	10 to 15 minutes
3. Collaboration and review	student voice, caregiver partnership, teacher consultation, documentation, and outcome monitoring	10 to 15 minutes

Module 1 Behaviour as communication

This module focuses on development, trauma, neurodiversity, culture, and avoiding punitive assumptions. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Development
- Trauma
- Neurodiversity
- Culture
- Avoiding punitive assumptions

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of behaviour as communication in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of development, trauma, neurodiversity, culture, and avoiding punitive assumptions. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through behaviour as communication safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Module 2 Tiered supports

This module focuses on classroom strategies, individual plans, crisis response, and referrals. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Classroom strategies
- Individual plans
- Crisis response
- Referrals

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of tiered supports in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of classroom strategies, individual plans, crisis response, and referrals. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through tiered supports safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Module 3 Collaboration and review

This module focuses on student voice, caregiver partnership, teacher consultation, documentation, and outcome monitoring. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Student voice
- Caregiver partnership
- Teacher consultation
- Documentation
- Outcome monitoring

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of collaboration and review in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of student voice, caregiver partnership, teacher consultation, documentation, and outcome monitoring. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through collaboration and review safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Course activity

Use the accompanying worksheet to apply the course sequence to a short case. Your completed activity should show what you noticed, the action you would take within your role, and what you would escalate or verify locally.

Assessment preparation

- Review the distinction between: trauma-informed practice.
- Review the distinction between: tiers of support.
- Review the distinction between: inclusive response.

References and local adaptation

- SWEEP Academy Course Content Outlines, production blueprint for this course.
- The current legislation, professional standards, safeguarding procedures, and referral directories for the delivery jurisdiction.
- The learner's employer or placement policy, supervision arrangements, and documentation standards.